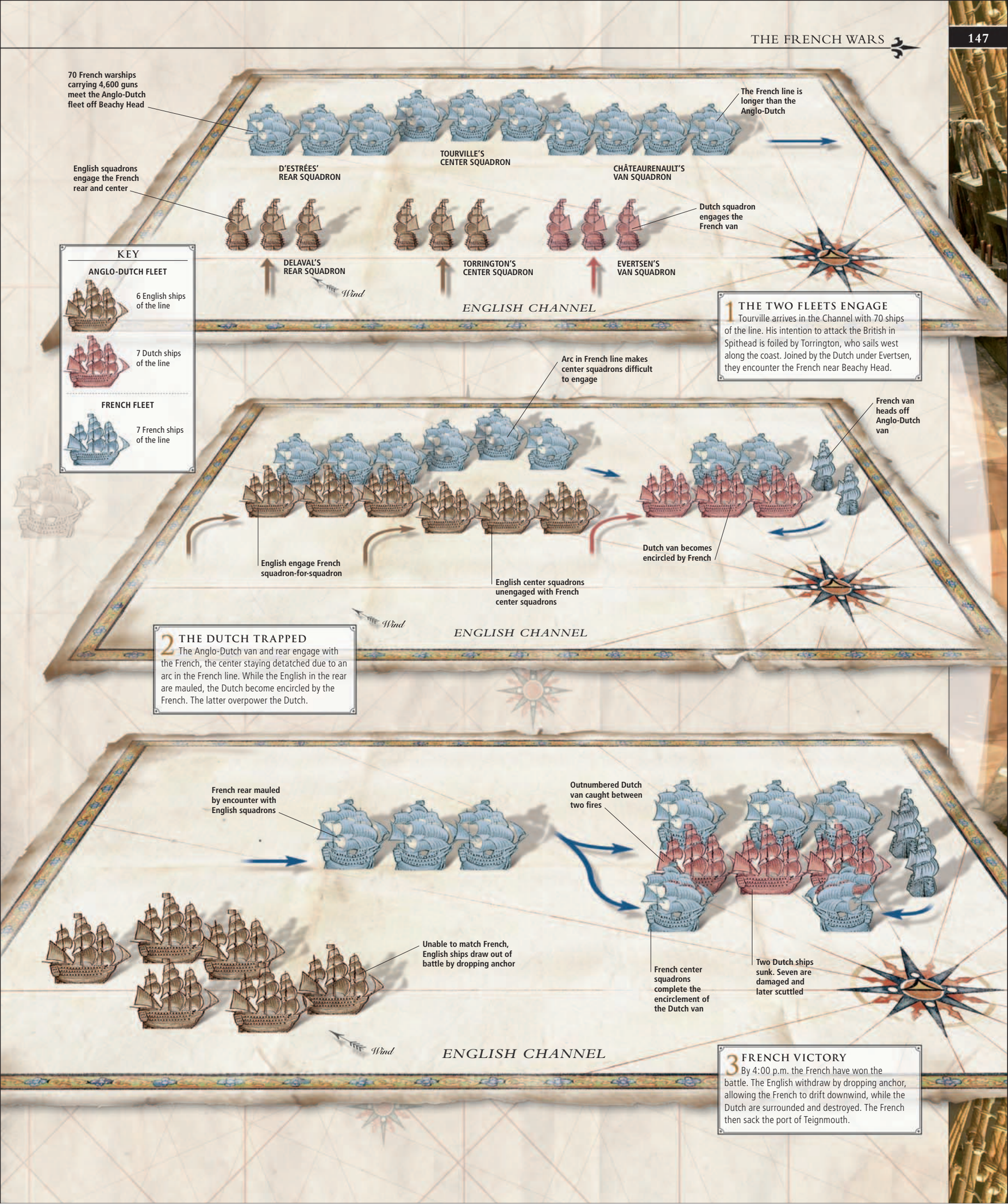

70 French warships carrying 4,600 guns meet the Anglo-Dutch fleet off Beachy Head
The French line is longer than the Anglo-Dutch
TOURVILLE'S CENTER SQUADRON
D'ESTRÉES' REAR SQUADRON
CHÂTEAURENAULT'S VAN SQUADRON
English squadrons engage the French rear and center
Dutch squadron engages the French van
KEY
ANGLO-DUTCH FLEET
6 English ships of the line
7 Dutch ships of the line
FRENCH FLEET
7 French ships of the line
DELAVAL'S REAR SQUADRON
TORRINGTON'S CENTER SQUADRON
EVERTSEN'S VAN SQUADRON
Wind
ENGLISH CHANNEL
1 THE TWO FLEETS ENGAGE
Tourville arrives in the Channel with 70 ships of the line. His intention to attack the British in Spithead is foiled by Torrington, who sails west along the coast. Joined by the Dutch under Evertsen, they encounter the French near Beachy Head.
Arc in French line makes center squadrons difficult to engage
French van heads off Anglo-Dutch van
English engage French squadron-for-squadron
Dutch van becomes encircled by French
English center squadrons unengaged with French center squadrons
Wind
ENGLISH CHANNEL
2 THE DUTCH TRAPPED
The Anglo-Dutch van and rear engage with the French, the center staying detatched due to an arc in the French line. While the English in the rear are mauled, the Dutch become encircled by the French. The latter overpower the Dutch.
French rear mauled by encounter with English squadrons
Outnumbered Dutch van caught between two fires
Unable to match French, English ships draw out of battle by dropping anchor
French center squadrons complete the encirclement of the Dutch van
Two Dutch ships sunk. Seven are damaged and later scuttled
Wind
ENGLISH CHANNEL
3 FRENCH VICTORY
By 4:00 p.m. the French have won the battle. The English withdraw by dropping anchor, allowing the French to drift downwind, while the Dutch are surrounded and destroyed. The French then sack the port of Teignmouth.